



Class 9 2022-23

INDIA: SIZE AND LOCATION

Ch 1 | Class 9 S.St. (Geography)

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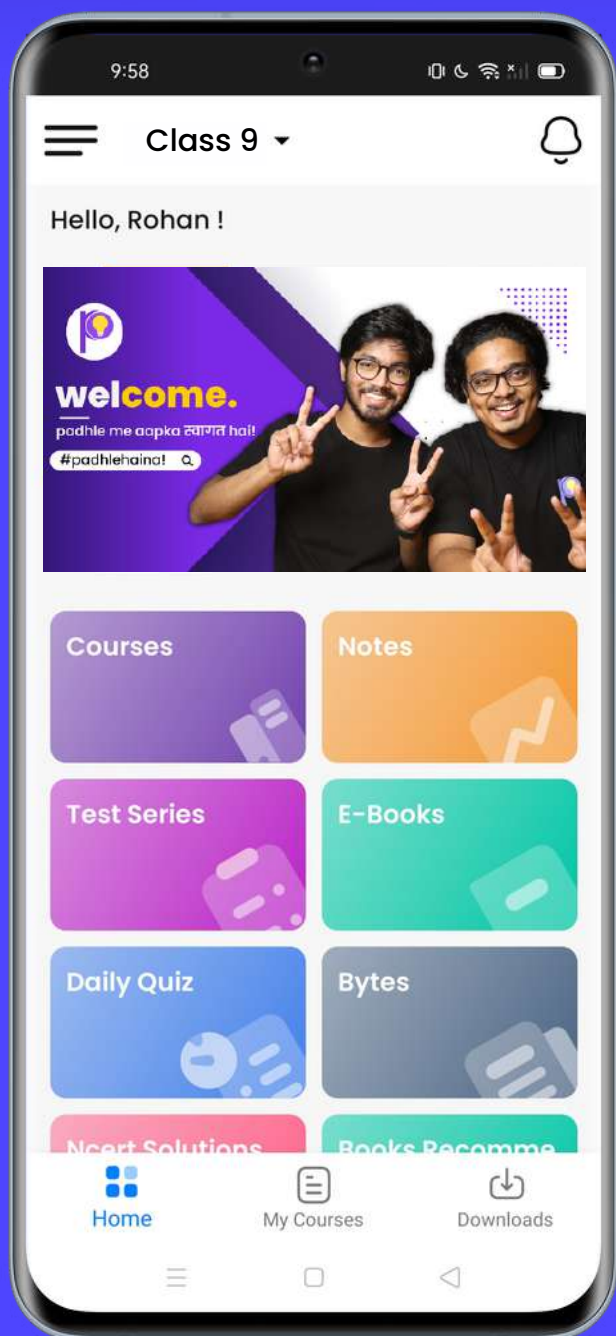
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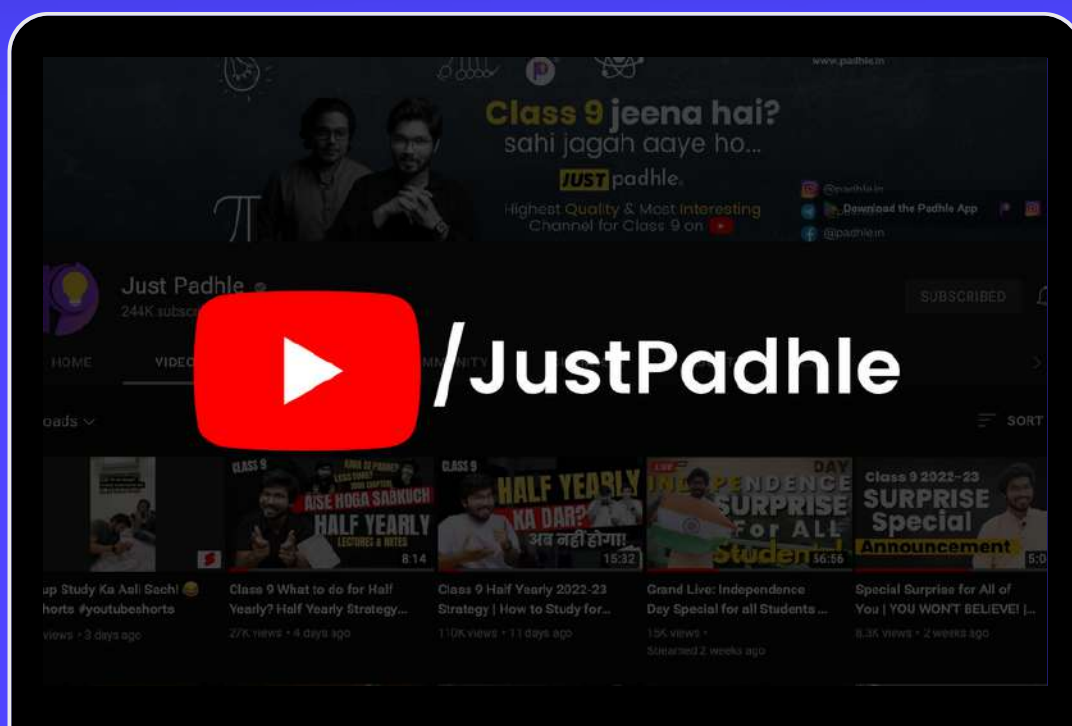
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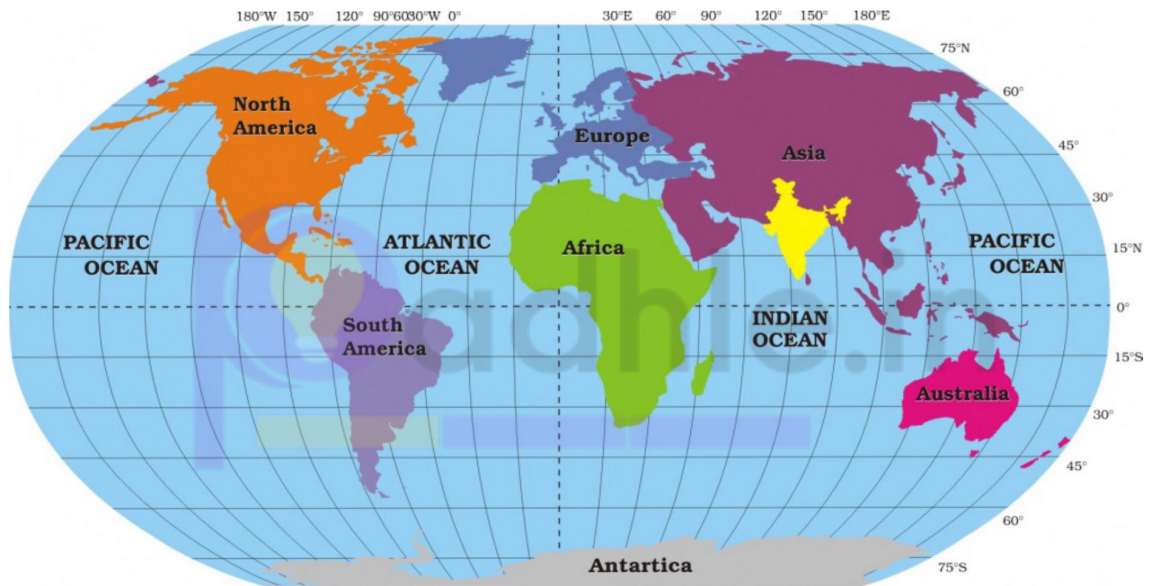
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INDIA - SIZE AND LOCATION

- ◇ India is one of the ancient civilizations in the world.
- ◇ It has achieved multi-faceted socio-economic progress during the last five decades.
- ◇ It has moved forward displaying remarkable progress.



* India in the World :

- Longitudes $68^{\circ}7'E$ and $97^{\circ}25'E$
- India is a vast country.
 - Lying entirely in the Northern hemisphere.
- Latitudes : $8^{\circ}4'N$ and $37^{\circ}6'N$
- The tropic of Cancer ($23^{\circ}30'N$) divides the country into almost two equal parts.



* Size :

- The land mass of India has an area of 3.28 million square km.
- Seventh largest country of the world.
- India's total area accounts for about 2.4 percent of the total geographical area of the world.
- India has a land boundary of about 15,200 km and the total length of the mainland, including Andaman and Nicobar and Lakshadweep, is 7,516.6 km.

* India's Geography :

♦ North India :

- India is bounded by the young fold mountains in the northwest, north and northeast.

❖ South India :

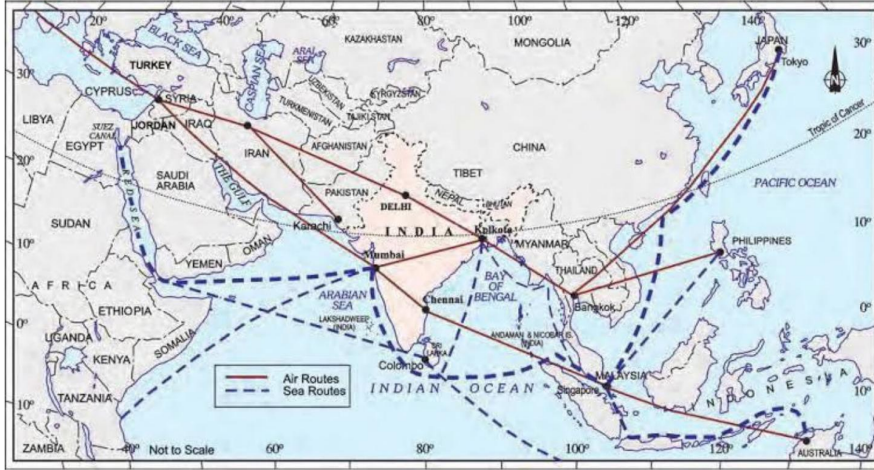
- South of about 22° north latitude, it begins to taper, and extends towards the Indian ocean, dividing it into two seas, the Arabian Sea on the west and the Bay of Bengal on its east.
- ❖ Latitudinal and longitudinal extent of the mainland is about 30° .
- ❖ From Gujarat to Arunachal Pradesh, there is a time lag of two hours.
- ❖ Hence, time along the Standard Meridian of India ($82^{\circ}30'E$) passing through Mirzapur (in Uttar Pradesh) is taken as the standard time for the whole country.

* India's Location in the world :

- ▷ India is located in the center of the world, between the East and the West Asia.
- ▷ India is a southward extension of the Asian continent.
- ▷ The trans Indian Ocean routes connect the countries of Europe in the West and the countries of East Asia.
- ▷ Thus India has strategic central location.
- ▷ The Deccan Peninsula protrudes into the Indian Ocean, thus helping India to establish close contact with West Asia, Africa and East Asia from the western coast and with Southeast and East Asia from the eastern coast.
- ▷ No other country has a long coastline on the Indian Ocean as India has and indeed, it is India's eminent position in the naming of an Ocean after it.



* India's Trade Relations :



- ▶ India's contacts with the World have continued through ages but her relationships through the land routes are much older than her maritime contacts.
- ▶ The various passes across the mountains in the north have provided restricted passages to the ancient travellers, while the oceans such interaction for a long time.
- ▶ These routes have contributed in the exchange of ideas and commodities since ancient times.
- ▶ The ideas of the Upanishads and the Ramayana, the stories of Panchatantra, the Indian numerals and the decimal system thus could reach many parts of the world.
- ▶ The spices, muslim and other merchandise were taken from India to different countries.
- ▶ On the other hand, the influence of Greek sculpture, and the architectural styles of dome and minerals from West Asia can be seen in different parts of our country.

* India's Neighbours :

- ▶ India occupies an important strategic position in South Asia.
- ▶ India has 28 states and 8 Union Territories.



- ▶ India shares its land boundaries with Pakistan and Afghanistan in the northwest.
- ▶ China (Tibet), Nepal and Bhutan in the north and Myanmar and Bangladesh in the east.
- ▶ Our southern neighbours across the sea consist of the two island countries, namely Sri Lanka and Maldives.
- ▶ Sri Lanka is separated from India by a narrow channel of sea formed by the Palk Strait and the Gulf of Mannar.
- ▶ While Maldives Islands are situated to the south of the Lakshadweep Islands.
- ▶ India has had strong geographical and historical links with her neighbours.
- ▶ Look at the physical map of Asia in your atlas, and note how India stands apart from the rest of Asia.